

Ghadir Tradition, The Expressive Evidence For Guardianship



**Islamic Sciences and Researches
Group – Qom**

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Article

Ghadir Tradition, The expressive evidence for guardianship Prepared by Islamic Sciences and Researches Group– Qom *The Ghadir tradition is one of the conclusive evidences for the immediate guardianship and caliphate of ‘Ali (a.s.) after the Prophet (s.a.w.a.), and the researchers render a special importance to it. This text provides you a handful of documents and references in this respect which will amaze the reader of how much proofs and evidences exist which was covered or neglected! These logical analyses and evidences derived from the Sunnite references are presented as a means of approaching the lines of world Muslims, and the facts which were previously left unattended to be taken into precise consideration, specially by the young generation. ******

Unprecedented offence!

In the open political climate recently established in the country, a number of Sunnite Molavi in the southern parts of the country, have started their offence to the Shiite beliefs (state’s official school) in contrary to their commitment on the issue of solidarity, an example of which is the article with the title of “The legendary of martyrdom of Hazrat Zahra (a.s.)”, which was published in the “Nedaye Islam” magazine (licensed by Ministry of Guidance), and we replied it decisively. Now, we came to know that one of the other southern Sunnite Molavi has stated provocative utterances in respect to “Ghadir tradition”, which is in contradiction with the facts existing in the tradition, history and biography books. It persuaded us to explain Ghadir tradition clearly and concisely, and let the public opinion to judge, to see what is the conclusion of offence to the state’s official school? And how long we shall be silent?!

Preface

You may have heard the name of Ghadir. It is a territory between Mecca and Medina, near Juhfah, which is 200 km far from Mecca. It is a cross road, where the pilgrims of different parts separate from each other: ● a road towards Medina, northward ● a road towards Iraq, eastward ● a road towards Egypt, westward ● a road towards Yemen, southward Today, it is an abandoned area, but once it was the witness of one the greatest events in the Islamic history, that is, the day of appointment of ‘Ali (a.s.) as the successor of Prophet (s.a.w.a.) (on eighteenth of Dhul-hijjah, 10th A.H.). Although for political purposes, the caliphs have tried to erase the memory of this great historical event, and now too, some of the fanatic individuals try to disappear or make it fade for some reasons, nevertheless, the dimensions of this event is too extensive in history, tradition and Arab literature, to be erased, covered or forgotten. In the present booklet, you will find the documents and references in this respect, so that you will be amazed, and may ask yourself that how such a lot of proofs and evidences could be covered or neglected?! We hope these logical analyses and evidences derived from the Sunnite references to be the means of approaching the lines of world Muslims, and the facts which were previously left unattended to be taken into precise consideration, specially by the young generation. *Islamic Sciences and Researches Group – Qom*

Ghadir Tradition, The expressive evidence for guardianship

Ghadir tradition is one of the conclusive evidences for the immediate guardianship and caliphate of ‘Ali (a.s.) after the Prophet (s.a.w.a.), and the researchers render a special importance to it. Unfortunately, those who prejudice with regard to his guardianship, once accept validity of the tradition, and express doubt for its implication, and once question about its authenticity. For clarification of different aspects of this tradition, it is necessary to talk about both groups with authentic and valid evidences:

Background of Ghadir

The “Farewell pilgrimage” ceremony was completed in the last month of the 10th A.H. The Muslims learned pilgrimage activities from the Prophet (s.a.w.a.), and then, Prophet (s.a.w.a.) decided to leave Mecca to Medina. He instructed for departure. When the caravan reached an area called “Rabegh” Rabegh is now located between Mecca and Medina., which is three miles far from Juhfah It is one of the trysting-places, and in the past, the course of people of Medina, Egypt and Iraq branched there., Gabriel, the inspiration angel, revealed in a point called “Ghadir Khom”, and addressed the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) with the following verse:

يَا أَيُّهَا الرَّسُولُ بَلِّغْ مَا أُنْزِلَ إِلَيْكَ مِنْ رَبِّكَ ۖ وَإِنْ لَمْ تَفْعَلْ فَمَا بَلَغْتَ رِسَالَتَهُ ۖ وَاللَّهُ يَعْصِمُكَ مِنَ النَّاسِ

O Messenger! proclaim the (message) which hath been sent to thee from thy Lord. If thou didst not, thou wouldst not have fulfilled and proclaimed His mission. And Allah will defend thee from men (who mean mischief). (sura al-Maidah, 5:67) The tone of verse indicates that God has assigned Prophet (s.a.w.a.) a critical mission, which equals with his prophetic mission, and caused despair of the Islam enemies. Is any critical mission more important than appointment of ‘Ali (a.s.) to the rank of caliphate, guardianship and succession in front of more than hundred thousand people?! Therefore, he ordered to stop. Those who were ahead of caravan, stopped, and those who were at the back of caravan, joined them. At noon, it was very hot, and a group of people put a part of their mantle on their head and a part under their foot. A shading was made for the Prophet through casting a veil on the tree. He sat on the high point, formed by the camel saddle, and he delivered a sermon with a loud voice, the extract of which follows.

Prophet’s (s.a.w.a.) sermon in Ghadir Khom

Praise belongs to God. We seek help from Him, and believe in Him, and trust in Him. We turn to Him for our evil and unrighteous deeds. The Lord, save whom there is no guide. Whoever is guided by Him, there will be no deviator for him. I testify that there is no God, save Him, and Mohammad is his servant and prophet. O people! Soon, I will die, and leave you. I am responsible and you too! Then he added: What do you think about me!? (Have I fulfilled my responsibility against you?) The crowd all said: We

testify that you have accomplished your prophetic mission, and endeavored. God may grant you good rewards. The Prophet (s.a.w.a.) said: Do you testify that the Lord of world is one, and Mohammad is His servant and prophet, and there is no doubt about paradise, hell, the everlasting life in the other world? All replied: Yes, that is right. We testify! He added: O people, I leave among you two precious things. I shall see how you treat with my two heritage?! One stood up and asked loudly: What are these two precious things?! Prophet (s.a.w.a.) said: One is divine book, one side of which is in the powerful hand of God, and the other is with you. And the next is my Household. God has informed me that these two will never separate! Beware, O People, do not surpass Quran and my Household. Do not fail to follow both of them. Otherwise, you will perish! Then, he took 'Ali's hand (a.s.), and raised it too high that the armpit of both of them was seen by the people, and introduced him to the people. He asked: Who is more authorized and rightful to the believers than themselves? All replied: God and His messenger are more aware. The Prophet (s.a.w.a.) said: God is my master and I am the master of believers, and I am more authorized and rightful than themselves! Beware, O People!

من كنت مولاه فهذا علي مولاه

Whoever I am his master and authority, this 'Ali will be his master and authority. The Prophet repeated this phrase for three times to avoid any future mistake!

اللهم وال من والاه و عاد من عاداه و احب من احبه و ابغض من ابغضه و انصر من نصره و اخذل من خذله و ادر الحق معه حيث دار.

O God, be friend with whoever is friend with 'Ali, and be enemy with whoever is an enemy of 'Ali. Help whoever helps him, and leave whoever leaves him, make him the criteria of right! This part of Ghadir tradition, and sometimes its first part, without the second or visa versa, has been mentioned in the following documents: خصائص نسائي: p. 181; سنن ابن حنبل: vol. 1, p. 254; تاريخ دمشق: vol. 42, p. 207, 208 & 448; المستدرک على الصحيح: vol. 13, p. 135; المعجم الكبير: vol. 17, p. 39; سنن الترمذی: vol. 5, p. 633; المناقب خوارزمی: p. 104, and other books. If you study the above sermon A large group of known Sunnite scholars have narrated this sermon in their books, such as: سنن ابن احمد: vol. 1, p. 84, 88, 118, 119, 152, 281, 331, 332, 370; سنن ابن ماجه: vol. 1, p. 55, 58; المستدرک على الصحيحين حاكم نيشابوري: vol. 3, p. 118 & 613; سنن ترمذی: vol. 5, p. 633; تاريخ الخلفاء و سيوطی: p. 114, etc. carefully, there are quick evidences for Imamate of 'Ali (a.s.) in every phrase of it. (we will explain it soon).

The eternity of Ghadir event

The Wise God has willed the Ghadir historical event to remain in all ages and centuries, as a live history, attracting the hearts and minds, and the Islamic writers to discuss it in the commentary, history, tradition

and theology books, and the religious orators to deliver lectures about it, and call it one of the undeniable virtues of Imam 'Ali (a.s.). Not only the orators and lecturers, but also the poets too have been suggested by this event, and have lighted their literary talent through thinking and reflection on it, as well as increasing their loyalty to the owner of guardianship. They have left the best poems in different forms and various languages. (The Late Allamah Amini has mentioned an important part of Ghadir poems in every century of the Islamic history, while describing the attributes of the poets in the eleven volumes of Al-Ghadir book narrated from popular Islamic resources). In other words, no other historical event in the world, has been noted so much by different classes, including traditionist, commentator, theologian, philosopher, orator, poet, historian and biographer. One of the reasons for eternity of this tradition, is revelation of two Quranic verses In reference to Sura al-Maidah, 5:3 and 5:67. in respect to this event, and since Quran is eternal and everlasting, this historical event too will be never forgotten. It is noteworthy that referring to the history clarifies that eighteenth of Dhul-hijjah has been known among Muslims as the Eid Ghadir, so that Ibn Khalkan says about Mostalli Ibn Mostansar: The people paid homage to him on eighteenth of Dhul-hijjah, Eid Ghadir, 487 A.H. وفیات الأعیان : vol. 1, p. 60, and he writes about Mostansar Bellah Abidi: He passed away twelve nights before the end of Dhul-hijjah, 487 A.H. It is the same night of eighteenth of Dhul-hijjah, the night of Eid Ghadir. وفیات الأعیان : vol. 2, p. 223 It is interesting that Aboureyhan Birouni, in Assarol Baqieh, has called Eid Ghadir one of the feasts, which all Muslims celebrated it. ترجمة الآثار الباقية: 395; الغدير, vol. 1, p. 367. Not only Ibn Khalkan and Aboureyhan Birouni have called it an Eid, but also Thalebi, one of the other famous Sunnite scholars has called Ghadir one of the popular nights among the Islamic nation. ثمار القلوب: 511 This Islamic Eid dates back to the time of Prophet (s.a.w.a.), because on that day, the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) instructed the immigrants and helpers, and rather his wives, to go to 'Ali (a.s.) and congratulate to him for guardianship and Imamate. Zeid Ibn Arqam says: Abu Bakr, Umar, Uthman, Talha and Zubayr from among the immigrants were the first who paid homage to 'Ali (a.s.), but the congratulation and paying homage ceremonies was continued till sunset. Congratulation of Umar Ibn Khattab has been mentioned in many of Sunnite documents, such as, مسند ابن حنبل, vol. 6, p. 401; البداية و النهاية, vol. 5, p. 209; الفصول المهمة ابن, p. 40; فراءد السمطين, vol. 1, p. 71. Congratulation of Aboubakr, Umar, Uthman, Talha, Zubayr and others have been stated in other books: مناقب علی بن ابیطالب, composed by Ahmad Ibn Mohammad Tabari (Alghadir, vol. 1, p. 270).

110 people of tradition narrators

For showing importance of this historical event, it is enough to say that one hundred ten of the Prophet's (s.a.w.a.) companions have narrated it. The documents of these important resources will be mentioned all together. Of course, this does not mean that only these from among the host have narrated the event. Rather, we mean that in the books of Sunnite scholars, the names of one hundred ten people are mentioned. In the second Islamic century, called the age of followers, eighty nine of them have narrated this tradition. The narrators of Ghadir tradition, in the next centuries too are among the Sunnite scholars and leaders. Three hundred sixty of them have collected this tradition in their books, and a large group

have affirmed its validity and authenticity. A group of them have not contended with narration of the tradition, and have also written separate books with regards to its documents and contents. It is strange that the great Islamic historian, Tabari, has composed a book, *الولاية في طرق حديث الغدير*, and has narrated the tradition based on seventy five chains of transmission from the Prophet! Ibn Oqdeh Koufi has narrated it from one hundred five people in the, *ولايت*, essay. Abu Bakr Mohammad Ibn Umar Baghdadi, known as Jamani, has narrated it through twenty five chains of transmission.

Sunnite Celebrated People

Ahmad Ibn Hanbal Sheybani Ibn Hajar Asqalani Jazari Shafei Abu Saeid Sajestani Amir Mohammad Yamani Nessaei Abolalae Hamedani and Abolerfan Haban have narrated the tradition through numerous chains of transmission. All of these documents are available in the first volume of *Alghadir* book, which are generally collected from the known Sunnite references. Shiite scholars too have composed valuable books regarding this historical event, and have referred to the Sunnite important references, the most comprehensive of which is the historical book, *الغدير*, composed by the late Ayatullah Amini. (This book has been the main reference in composition of this article). However, after appointment of ‘Ali (a.s.) as his successor, the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) said: O People, just now the inspiration angel revealed to me and brought this verse:

...الْيَوْمَ أَكْمَلْتُ لَكُمْ دِينَكُمْ وَأَتَمَمْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ نِعْمَتِي وَرَضِيتُ لَكُمُ الْإِسْلَامَ دِينًا...

This day have I perfected your religion for you, completed My favour upon you, and have chosen for you Islam as your religion. (Surah al-Maidah, 5:3) Then the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) said “Allahu Akbar” and added: I thank God for perfecting His religion, and completing His Blessing, and approving my mission and guardianship and succession of ‘Ali after me. Then, Prophet (s.a.w.a.) came down, and said ‘Ali (a.s.): Sit under a tent so that the prominent Islamic chiefs and headmen pay homage and congratulate to you. First of all, Umar and Abu Bakr congratulated to ‘Ali (a.s.) and called him their master! Hassan Ibn Thabet availed himself of the opportunity and asking permission from the Prophet (s.a.w.a.), versified some poems, and read them before the Prophet (s.a.w.a.). Hereunder we will mention only two couplets of it:

فقال له قم يا علي فأنى

رضيتك من بعدى اماماً و هادى

فمن كنت مولاه فهذا وليه

فكونوا له اتباع صدق موالى

He said ‘Ali: Get up, I selected you for succession and guidance of people after me. Whoever I am his master and authority, this ‘Ali will be his master and authority, and you loving him heartily, follow him. The poems of Hassan have been stated in several resources: مقتل الحسين خوارزمي, p. 135, مناقب خوارزمي, vol. 1, p. 47, فرائد السمطين, vol. 1, p. 73 & 74; النور المشتغل, p. 56; المناقب كوثر, vol. 1, p. 118 & 362. This tradition has been one of the greatest evidences for excellence of Imam ‘Ali (a.s.) over all the Prophet’s (s.a.w.a.) companions. Even, in the caliphate council meeting, hold after demise of the second caliph This argument has been stated in the following books: فرائد السمطين, p. 217; مناقب اخطب خوارزمي حنفي, p. 7, 212, امالي ابن عقده, p. 75; الدر النظيم ابن حاتم شامي, الصواعق المحرقة ابن حجر عسقلاني, chapter 58; حموي, vol. 2, p. 61, شرح نهج البلاغه ابن ابي الحديد, vol. 3, p. 418 under verse 55, Sura al-Maidah., as well as during the caliphate of Uthman, and his own caliphate, Imam ‘Ali (a.s.) has argued it. فرائد السمطين, first part, chapter 58; شرح نهج البلاغه ابن ابي الحديد, vol. 1, p. 362; اسد الغابه, vol. 3, p. 307, vol. 5, p. 205; الاصابه ابن حجر عسقلاني, vol. 2, p. 408, vol. 4, p. 80; مسند احمد, vol. 1, p. 84, 88; نخائر العقبي, vol. 9, p. 106; مجمع الزوائد هيثمي, vol. 5, p. 210, vol. 7, p. 348; البداية و النهاية ابن كثير شامي, 67, ... (الغدير), p. 163, 164) Moreover, the great personalities, like Hazrat Zahra (a.s.) have repeatedly reasoned the tradition against the opponents and deniers of the high rank of ‘Ali (a.s.). اسنى المطالب شمس شرح, vol. 2, p. 297; البدر الطالع شوكانى, vol. 9, p. 256; سخاوى فى الضوء اللامع, الدين شافعى, vol. 2, page 273; مناقب علامه حنفى, p. 130; بلاغات النساء, vol. 1, p. 486. ينابيع الموده, vol. 2, page 49; مروج الذهب ابن مسعود شافعى, vol. 1, page 259, صبح الاعشى, 162;

To whom does the word master and authority (مولى) apply?

The main issue here is the interpretation of concept of master, that while being clear and obvious, it has been unfairly judged. Considering the aforementioned explanation, there would remain no doubt and uncertainty about the authenticity of the tradition, the excuse seekers created doubt and uncertainty about the meaning and concept of tradition, particularly the word

،مولا .مولا،

in this tradition, and rather in most cases, has only one meaning, that is, priority and qualification, and in other words, guardianship. Quran has applied the word, **مولا**, for the concept of guardian and authority. The word, **مولا**, has been applied in 18 Quranic verses, 10 of which is concerned with God. It goes without saying that it indicates His authority and guardianship, and only in some few cases, it has been applied for friendship. Therefore, there shall be no doubt that the word, **مولا**, primarily means the superior and authority. In Ghadir tradition too, it has the same meaning. In addition, it is accompanied with so many evidences and proofs, clearly proving that it means authority and guardianship.

The evidences certifying this claim

Even supposing that the term, مولا, has lexically various meanings, but there are many evidences and proofs in the Ghadir tradition and this great historical event, removing any ambiguity and conclusive for all.

First evidence

As we said, on the day of Ghadir historical event, Hassan Ibn Thabet, Prophet's (s.a.w.a.) poet, asked permission from the Prophet (s.a.w.a.), and versified Prophet's (s.a.w.a.) utterance. This eloquent and fluent poet, having command on Arabic language, applied Imam and guide for the word, مولى, and said:

فقال له: قم يا على فأننى

رضيتك من بعدى اماماً و هادى

He said 'Ali: Get up, I selected you for succession and guidance of people after me. The documents for attribution of these poems to Hassan Ibn Thabet was already mentioned. As it is clear, he had not understood the word, مولى, in the Prophet's (s.a.w.a.) utterance, anything save the rank of Imamate, leadership and guardianship of the nation, while he knew well Arabic terminology and was one of the eloquent Arab poets. Not only Hassan, the great Arab poet, has understood this concept from the word, مولى, but also other great Islamic poets, most of which have been among the famous Arab poets and literati, and some of them have been the great professors in this language, have understood the same concept which Hassan did, that is, Imamate and leadership of nation!

Second evidence

Imam 'Ali (a.s.) in his poems writing to Moavieh regarding Ghadir tradition says:

و اوجب لى ولايته عليكم

رسول الله يوم غدیر خم

God's Prophet (s.a.w.a.) enjoined my guardianship for you on the day of Ghadir Khom. The Late Allamah Amini, in vol. 2 of Al-Ghadir, p. 25-30, has narrated this poems with other couplets from 11 of Shiite and 26 of Sunnite scholars. Who can interpret the tradition and explain for us what the God's Prophet (s.a.w.a.) meant by, ولايت, on the Ghadir day, better than Imam? Does this interpretation show

not that as all present in the Ghadir event believe, it does not imply anything save social leadership and headship?

Third evidence

Before stating the phrase,

من كنت مولاه

... the Prophet asked:

الست اولى بكم من انفسكم؟

Am I not more authorized and rightful to you than yourselves? In the above phrase, Prophet (s.a.w.a.) has applied

اولى به نفس

and has asked all people for confession to his authority over them. Then, he immediately said:

من كنت مولاه فهذا على مولاه

Whoever I am his master and authority, this 'Ali will be his master and authority. What is the purpose of conjunction in these two phrases? Is it anything save proving the same rank of Prophet (s.a.w.a.) as per the text of Quran, for 'Ali (a.s.)? The only difference is that he is the prophet and 'Ali is Imam. On this account, it is interpreted as: Whoever I am his master and authority, this 'Ali will be his master and authority. Allamah Amini has narrated the phrase, الست اولى بكم من انفسكم, from 64 Islamic traditionists and historians. Refer to vol. 1, p. 371. If the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) meant something else, there was no reason for asking people's confession for his mastership and authority. It is very unfair if one neglects this message of Prophet (s.a.w.a.), and does not take into account such obvious evidence.

Fourth evidence

The Prophet (s.a.w.a.) asked for people's confession to three basic Islamic principles and said:

الستم تشهدون ان لا اله الا الله و ان محمداً عبده و رسوله و ان الجنة حق و النار حق؟

Do you testify that the Lord of world is one, and Mohammad is His servant and prophet, and there is no doubt about paradise, hell? What did he mean for asking the confession? Does he want to make people's mind ready to consider the rank and position, which he will later prove for 'Ali (a.s.), as the previous tenets, and know that confession to his caliphate and guardianship is the same as triple tenets of religion, to which all confess? If the word,

مولى

, meant friend and helper, the sentences lose their relation, and the utterances is not firm anymore. Don't you think so?

Fifth evidence

At the beginning of his sermon, the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) talks about his death and says:

انى أوشك أن ادعى فاجيب

Soon, I will die. Refer to Al-Ghadir, vol. 1, p. 26,27,30,32,333,34,36,47,176. The chain of transmission of this subject from the Sunnite documents, such as: صحيح ترمذى, vol. 2, p. 298; الفصول المهمة ابن صباغ, p. 25; البداية و النهاية ابن كثير, vol. 5, p. 209, vol. 7, p. 348; الصواعق المحرقة, p. 25; مجمع الزوائد هيثمى, vol. 9, p. 165,... The phrase indicates that the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) is going to make a decision for the period after himself, and fill the vacancy caused by his demise. What can fill such vacancy, is appointment of a successor, worthy and informed to manage the affairs after him, and nothing else. If we interpret guardianship to something save caliphate, the logical relation of the Prophet's (s.a.w.a.) utterances is clearly disturbed, while he is one of the most eloquent and fluent orators. What other clearer evidence could be found for guardianship?

Sixth evidence

... من كنت مولاه

the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) said:

الله اكبر على اكمال الدين و اتمام النعمة و رضى الرب برسالتى و الولاية لعلى من بعدى

"Allahu Akbar", I thank God for perfecting His religion, and completing His Blessing, and approving my mission as well as guardianship and succession of 'Ali after me. If he meant friendship and assistance of

one of the Muslims, how the God's religion was perfected, and His blessing was completed through friendship with 'Ali (a.s.)? More obviously, he says: God approved my mission and guardianship of 'Ali (a.s.) after me. The late Allamah Amini has mentioned the documents for this part of tradition in vol. 1, p. 43, 165, 231, 232, 233, 235, like: تفسير ابن كثير; vol. 2, p. 14; تفسير الدر المنثور; vol. 2, p. 259; ما نزل من القرآن في علي, ابونعيم اصفهاني, تاريخ خطيب; p. 220; مفتاح النجاح بدخشي; vol. 1, p. 31; الاتقان; vol. 4, p. 290; بغدادى; p. 18; تذكره سبط بن جوزى; p. 43; الخصائص العلويه ابوالفتح نطنزى; p. 80; مناقب خوارزمى; chapter 12. Are these not clear evidences for the concept of caliphate?

Seventh evidence

What evidence is more explanatory than congratulation of Umar and Abu Bakr, and a large number of the Prophet's (s.a.w.a.) companions to 'Ali (a.s.) lasting till the time of sunset prayer, while Umar and Abu Bakr were the first of those who congratulated Imam as follows:

هنيئاً لك يا علي بن ابي طالب اصبحت و أمسيت مولاي و مولى كل مؤمن و مؤمنه

Congratulations to you, O 'Ali Ibn Abu Talib, you wake up and go to sleep, while you are my guardian, and the guardian of any believer man and woman! For information about the documents indicating congratulation of Umar & Abu Bakr, refer to Al-Ghadir, vol. 1, p. 270, 283. A part of documents of this tradition was already stated. What position did 'Ali (a.s.) achieve on that day to be worthy of such congratulation? Is any rank, save leadership and caliphate of the Islamic nation that was not officially declared till then, worthy of such congratulation? Friendship and kindness was not a new issue.

Eighth evidence

If friendship of 'Ali (a.s.) was meant, it was not necessary to express it in such a hot weather (stopping one hundred thousand caravan, and asking the people to sit on the hot sands in the desert for delivering a lecture)! Quran had already called all the society's individuals as brothers, and it says:

إِنَّمَا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ إِخْوَةٌ فَأَصْلَحُوا بَيْنَ أَخَوَيْكُمْ ۚ وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُرْحَمُونَ

The Believers are but a single Brotherhood: So make peace and reconciliation between your two (contending) brothers; and fear Allah, that ye may receive Mercy. (Surah al-Hujurat, 49: 10) Had Quran not already introduced the believers as friends? 'Ali (a.s.) too was one of the believers, and there was no need for declaring his friendship. Even if it was expedient to declare his friendship, these preparations and hard conditions were not required. It was possible to be declared in Medina. Surely, the issue has been more important, requiring such exceptional preparations, which were unprecedented in the Prophet's (s.a.w.a.) life, and it was not repeated anymore.

Now let's judge!

With such clear evidences, isn't it strange if someone doubt about the Prophet's (s.a.w.a.) purpose, that is, caliphate and leadership of Muslims? How do those who doubt, persuade their conscience and what's their reply to God on the day of resurrection? Verily, if all Muslims start a new study and review on the Ghadir tradition, free from any prejudice, they will reach desirable conclusions, and it will cause more solidarity among the Muslims.

Question

It is remarkable that some say that the president, has interpreted the word, مولا , as friendship, in one of his elective lectures, while he is one of the Shiite clergymen.

Reply

It is not true, because soon later, for removing any ambiguity and misunderstanding, he clarified in the explanation published in many of dailies as follows: I shall remark the point, which I mentioned in one of my recent lectures about the Ghadir event, that is, kindness and affection has a critical role in the God's religion, and particularly in the social life of the Islamic society. However, considering the time, place and the homage paid to 'Ali (a.s.) on the same day, by the word, مولى, in the phrase, من كنت مولاه فهذا علي موله, the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) surely meant guardianship and leadership of the Islamic society, and as we Shiite believe, and as per the authentic historical narration after demise of Prophet (s.a.w.a.), this concept has been accepted and approved by the Prophet's (s.a.w.a.) great companions. On the other hand, the word, مولى, conveys a special message and has been selected knowingly. Surely the Prophet could apply other phrases such as, قائد, سلطان, امير, but the word, مولى, includes friendship and kindness (one of the bases of desirable Islamic government) in addition to guardianship. Today, our nation wants to enjoy a free and improved society, as well as growth with spirituality, morality and kindness. Islamic Sciences & Researches Group – Qom

Three meaningful traditions!

1- Who is right?

Umm Salamah and 'Ayshah, Prophet's (s.a.w.a.) wives said: We heard from the Prophet (s.a.w.a.):

على مع الحق و الحق مع على لن يفترقا حتى يردا على الحوض

'Ali is with right, and right is with 'Ali, they do not separate each other until appearing to me besides the Pond of Abundance. This tradition has been narrated in many of Sunnite popular resources. Allamah Amini has mentioned these resources exactly in the third volume of Al-Ghadir. Mohammad Ibn Abu

Bakr, Abu Dharr, Abu Saeid Khadri, and others have narrated this tradition from the Prophet (s.a.w.a.). (Refer to vol. 3, Al-Ghadir). The famous Sunnite commentator, Fakhr Razi, in his commentary book, under the Opening sura says: ‘Ali Ibn Abu Talib (a.s.) recited

"بسم الله"

loudly, and it has been proved by repeated transmission. Whoever follows ‘Ali in his religion, he has been guided, as the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) says:

اللهم ادر الحق مع علي حيث دار

O God, make him the criteria of right, to wherever he turns. تفسير كبير, vol. 1, p. 205. Pay attention. It says the right turns to wherever he turns!

2- Pledge of brotherhood

A group of known companions of the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) have narrated following tradition from the Prophet (s.a.w.a.):

آخى رسول الله (صلى الله عليه وآله) بين اصحابه فاخى بين ابي بكر و عمر، و فلان و فلان، فجاء علي (رضي الله عنه) فقال آخيت بين اصحابك و لم تواخ بيني و بين احد؟! فقال رسول الله (صلى الله عليه وآله) انت اخي في الدنيا و الآخرة.

The Prophet (s.a.w.a.) set the pledge of brotherhood between his companions, such as between Umar and Abu Bakr, and the others (those in the same rank). Then, ‘Ali (a.s.) came to him and said: You set the pledge of brotherhood for all, but not between anyone and me? The Prophet (s.a.w.a.) said: You are my brother in the world and hereafter. The same content with similar phrases has been stated in 49 other cases. These traditions are generally found in the Sunnite resources! Allamah Amini has stated all of these fifty traditions, and its documents and resources in details in the third volume of Al-Ghadir. Isn't the pledge of brotherhood between ‘Ali and the Prophet (s.a.w.a.) a proof for his excellence and superiority to the all nation? Is it possible to prefer someone to the superior?

3- The sole means of salvation

Keeping in hand the door of Kabah, Abu Dharr called:

من عرفني (فقد عرفني) و من لم يعرفني فانا ابوزر، سمعت النبي (صلى الله عليه وآله) يقول: مثل اهل بيتي فيكم مثل سفينة نوح، من ركبها نجي و من تخلف عنها غرق

Whoever knows me, he knows, and whoever doesn't know me, may know that I am Abu Dharr. I heard from the Prophet (s.a.w.a.): The similitude of my Household is like that of Noah ship. Whoever enters it, is saved, and whoever leaves it, will be drowned. The references of the above tradition are very numerous, to which will be referred in the footnote. مستدرک حاکم, vol. 2, p. 150, (published in Heydarabad), and at least 30 other books from the Sunnite known resources, have narrated it. When Noah typhoon happened on the earth, there was no salvation means, save Noah ship. Even the high mountains could not deliver Noah's son who had associated with the evil-doers. As per the saying of the Prophet (s.a.w.a.), is there any way for salvation of the nation after him, save resorting to the Household (a.s.)?

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